

DSide Consulting

PT Technology Assessment Framework

A structured evaluation tool for PT practice owners and PE-backed platforms | Tech for PT. PT for Tech.

Most PT practices are making technology decisions without a structured framework for evaluation. The result: underutilized tools, failed implementations, and technology budgets that don't move the needle. This framework gives practice owners and operators a consistent lens for assessing any technology investment — before the purchase, during implementation, and at the point of operational review.

Clinical Technology Fit

Does this tool belong in your clinical environment?

Evaluate whether the technology genuinely addresses a clinical need present in your practice — not a need the vendor created. The best clinical technology integrates into existing patient workflows without disrupting the therapeutic relationship or adding documentation burden.

KEY EVALUATION QUESTIONS

- What specific clinical problem does this solve — and do we have that problem?
- Have clinicians been involved in the evaluation process?
- Does this improve patient outcomes, clinician efficiency, or both?
- What is the learning curve and how does it affect throughput during onboarding?
- Is the vendor's clinical evidence peer-reviewed or internally generated?

GREEN SIGNALS

Clinicians request it. Outcomes data is independent. Fits into visit workflow without added documentation.

RED FLAGS

Vendor defines the problem. No clinical validation. Requires workflow redesign to function.

Operations & EMR Integration

Will this work inside how your practice actually runs?

Operational technology only delivers value when it integrates with your existing systems and staff workflows. A tool that works in isolation creates parallel processes, increases administrative load, and will be abandoned within 90 days.

KEY EVALUATION QUESTIONS

- Does this integrate with our current EMR — natively or via API?
- What is the implementation timeline and who on our team owns it?
- How does this affect front desk, billing, and scheduling workflows?
- What does the vendor's implementation support look like after go-live?
- What happens to our data if we discontinue the product?

GREEN SIGNALS

Native EMR integration. Dedicated implementation support.
Clear data portability terms.

RED FLAGS

Manual data entry required. Implementation left to the practice. No data export guarantee.

Data & Reporting Readiness

Can your practice generate and act on the data this tool produces?

AI and analytics tools are only as valuable as the data infrastructure beneath them. Before adopting any data-driven technology, a practice must assess whether it has the data hygiene, reporting literacy, and operational bandwidth to use the output.

KEY EVALUATION QUESTIONS

- What data does this tool require as input — and is ours clean and structured?
- Who in our practice will own the reporting function?
- How does this tool's output connect to a specific operational or clinical decision?
- What does the dashboard look like in practice — and will our team actually use it?
- What is the baseline we're measuring against, and how will we define success?

GREEN SIGNALS

Clear KPIs tied to existing decisions. Data ownership stays with the practice. Reporting is actionable, not decorative.

RED FLAGS

Output requires data science interpretation. No baseline defined. Reporting disconnected from operations.

PE & Exit Readiness

Does this technology strengthen your platform's valuation story?

For PE-backed platforms and practices considering acquisition, technology infrastructure is increasingly a valuation lever. Acquirers evaluate data quality, operational scalability, and technology standardization across locations. The right technology stack is a competitive asset at exit.

KEY EVALUATION QUESTIONS

- Does this tool produce outcomes data that strengthens our clinical story for acquirers?
- Is this technology scalable across multiple locations without re-implementation?
- How does this fit into a standardized technology stack across the platform?
- Does this vendor have enterprise contracts or MSA structures for multi-site groups?
- Would a sophisticated acquirer view this as infrastructure or overhead?

GREEN SIGNALS

Scalable licensing. Standardizable across locations.
Produces outcomes data with benchmark potential.

RED FLAGS

Site-specific implementation. No enterprise contract structure. Output not exportable or reportable at scale.

Ready to assess your technology stack?

dsideconsulting.com · daniel@dsideconsulting.com